

Chapter 111-3

"Her diary only mentioned two people—one was you, and one was Chen Mian." Gu Xingyue rapidly relayed the information. "She was seen walking together with Chen Mian by Yang Jiani. In fact, it was because it was raining that day, and Chen Mian held an umbrella to walk her to the school gate. The two of them were pushing the umbrella back and forth between each other, and their hands accidentally touched. Yang Jiani thought she was in a puppy love relationship, and then her hands were beaten swollen with a ruler."

"Yang Jiani's possessiveness had reached an appalling level. She didn't allow anyone else to get close to Qi Jiao, nor did she allow Qi Jiao to make friends. So Qi Jiao was often alone at school, and her interactions with Chen Mian weren't many. After reading her diary, I always thought it was her one-sided secret crush on Chen Mian. But the night before last, Chen Mian seemed to have been drunk."

After Gu Xingyue finished speaking, she played a recording for Liang Shi.

In her impression, Chen Mian's voice was very cold and clear, her tone somewhat arrogant and not very likeable, but she also didn't talk to people much.

Yet in this recording, Chen Mian's voice was quite soft. You could tell she had drunk too much. When calling Qi Jiao's name, her voice was gentle and lingering with affection.

She said, "Qi Jiao, I dreamed of you again. Are you doing okay? I miss you."

She also said, "Qi Jiao, don't jump... don't jump... I wasn't there below to catch you."

"Where did you go? To be honest, there was a period of time when I really hated you, because you disappeared for no reason. Later, I stopped hating you, because I found out that you died. How could you have died? Someone who was fine even after jumping off the rooftop—how could you die?"

"But how ridiculous. As soon as you died, your mother found a replacement. How could someone like that be worthy of being a mother?"

Chen Mian's voice gradually became drowsy. "Ah Jiao, if only I had the ability to hide you away."

The recording ended there. Liang Shi listened with mixed emotions.

If only there had really been someone who could have hidden Qi Jiao away back then.

But there were no "if onlys."

Gu Xingyue said, "If you know her, tell her not to call anymore. I'm afraid Yang Jiani will find out."

Her voice was very cold.

But Liang Shi heard a hint of determination in it. She looked at her and asked, "What are you planning to do?"

"Haven't figured it out yet." Gu Xingyue curved her lips into a smile. "But it should be something interesting."

That smile carried a hint of madness.

"I've hidden the original of Qi Jiao's diary." Gu Xingyue said, "What I gave you is all hand-copied by me. I didn't add or remove a single sentence. Also, pass this on to my brother."

The brother she referred to was Gu Zhaoyuan.

Gu Xingyue handed over a blue envelope. "He'll understand when he sees it."

Liang Shi put away the envelope. Seeing that something was off about her, she couldn't help but say, "Mr. Gu was very disappointed when he didn't get to see you last time. He misses you very much. And Director Gu—because he sent you away and saw Yang Jiani abuse you, he feels very guilty. Angel Orphanage has now been converted into Ci'ai Nursing Home¹. Director Gu's mental state isn't very good right now, and his health is also deteriorating. So if you have time and are able to, I can take you there to see him."

"No need." Gu Xingyue pressed her lips together. "The director would definitely be even more upset if he saw me. When the time comes, if possible, I just want to see my brother."

Liang Shi acknowledged with a sound and said she was willing to help.

They had pretty much said everything that needed to be said. Liang Shi also thought of Cheng Ran, hesitating whether to tell Gu Xingyue about Cheng Ran's scummy words.

While she was hesitating, Gu Xingyue picked up the teapot beside her to add more tea. As she raised her hand, Liang Shi saw the blood marks on her wrist.

Liang Shi immediately grabbed her wrist and pulled up her sleeve.

On her wrist was a bloody mark that had already scabbed over. It was a shocking sight.

But from this mark, you could also tell how deep she had cut before.

"Why?" Liang Shi asked coldly.

"Otherwise, why do you think I have any freedom?" Gu Xingyue smiled and pulled her sleeve back down, covering that mark. "One always has to fight for something for oneself."

Looking at Gu Xingyue's cold and detached eyes, Liang Shi felt as if she was only now truly getting to know her.

A few seconds later, Liang Shi spoke the words that Cheng Ran had asked her to pass on. "Cheng Ran said that she also had thirty percent sincerity toward you."

Upon hearing this, Gu Xingyue was stunned. After a long while, she laughed.

On that seemingly docile face was a disdainful smile. "Who cares."

1. "Ci'ai" (慈愛) means "loving kindness" or "benevolent love" in Chinese, a fitting name for a nursing home. ⇐